

20/5/2026

Classification of Library Materials

Library classification is a systematic arrangement of human knowledge, recorded in various documents deposited in the library, eg books, serials, tape, microfilm, maps, computer disc,

Library classification assigns each item to its specific class which in most systems is subdivided by subject. For example, religion, economics, education and Agriculture, and distinct subjects should be placed in different places.

Library classification aims at arranging information in a logical sequence on the shelf and providing subject analysis of the subject.

For example all Science materials should be kept together

Books are generally arranged by Symbol notationally on the shelf.

Library are information centre, classifying by grouping

Aims and Objective of Classification in the library

1. Ensure the maximum use of library books and to decrease and if possible stop the loss of time and time loss to unguide

Objective:-

- (i) Shelf arrangement of books in helpful order
- (ii) Arrangement of books by subject
- (iii) Bringing users in contact to specific books or as user requested

Ranganathan's Contribution to Classification

Five Laws of Library Science

- (i) Books are for use
 - (ii) Every user is a book
 - (iii) Every book ^{has} ~~costs~~ users.
 - (iv) Do not waste the time of library user
 - (v) The library is a growing organism.
- (i) Books are for use, therefore means all books acquire are for user used, newly acquired books should be processed quickly and them to the shelf so that user can use it soonest.
- (ii) (iii) Every user is books & book is user! This too principle to consider the environment of the library should be classified base on their understanding of the subject of the book, this is often influence by the environment and the understanding, and background of the users.
- (iii) Do not waste the time of library user :- ~~you must~~ ^{you must} classified the once a book is wrongly classified, it will take a long time to find them, place the right materials in the right shelf, classify them in the right position

(v) The library is a growing organism :- this principle means that there should be constant acquisition and preservation. As the material are brought in the library there must be constant classification, therefore classifying and cataloguing is constant routine job going on in the library.

P M E S T

P - Personality

M - Matter

E - Energy

S - Space

T - Time

P Personality :- represent the most important and appropriate in the subject

In classification, a personality of a subject is Consider first

Assignment

12026

Use of classification and their principles

1. Classification helps to arrange books in an orderly manner on the shelf
2. It is able to find or place books or related items together
3. From the catalogue you easily go straight to the books want
4. It is therefore offer the method and clear and effective shelve guidance
5. It saves a great deal of times when finding a book or retrieving an information materials on the shelf
6. Special tasks such as stock taking are heard by classification

Principles of Classification

1. The meaning and basic principles of classification is for the library and library users, ~~that~~
 - The librarian or classifier has to determine what the book or information materials is about before giving it the class number, and also place it where it's most useful to the library and information users.

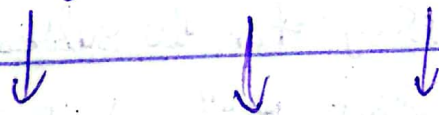
2. To be able to determine what the book is about we should be able to determine its subject, there are several methods of determining a book's

- i. Title : Studying of title of a book do not classify from the title
- ii. Table of Content : this is usually a very good guide since it contains the subject offered by the book
- iii. prefix : - is important as it will enlighten on the author's point of view, it also helps to confirm your guess
- iv. Introduction : - this is also very helpful in determining the subject. Preface by the book. Some of the introduction pages can

v Text :- A careful examination of the text is
will occasionally be necessary to determine
the subject.

vi Publisher's Blurb :- This is usually thrust comment
written by the publisher. It is short and gives an
insight into the subject.

All the books acquired by the library are required
to be classified according to the classification
Scheme choosing by the library, the principle
below apply as following :-



1. ~~Class~~ the books according to subject, then according
to which the form is represented.

this is crossly first to the subject before
the form to be considered.

2. Class a book where it will be most useful. For
example a book title 'introduction to librarianship'

will be most useful in librarianship than others

3. place a book is a most specific subject division rather than the general place.

4. When a book treat more than four subject place it in a general class

Step by step procedure in classifying a book

1. - determine exactly the subject of the book
2. - Use the index to select the appropriate main class
3. - Consult the Schedule to find the exact class of the subject
4. - If it is necessary for the subject to be given more specific place consult the table
5. - Write the subject number on the book.